Magic rule – Summoned creatures and companions · SRD 5.2.1

A **summoned creature** (*Summon Beast*, *Conjure Animals*…) acts **on its summoner's count**. A **familiar** (*Find Familiar*) rolls its **own initiative**. Both are **allies** controlled by the player.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. Summoned: **same initiative**, acts right after you.
2. It obeys your **verbal commands** (no action).
3. No command: it **Dodges** and avoids danger.
4. The spell often needs **Concentration**.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 standardizes: every "Summon…" spell gives a creature that acts right after its summoner and obeys its commands.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD doesn't say how far commands carry. Fix: they carry as long as the creature can hear or see the summoner.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe the creature as a stylized spirit shaped by the summoner.

Step 1 – Cast:

Choose the slot level: it determines the creature's statistics.

Step 2 – Concentration:

Maintain it to keep the creature (usually up to 1 hour).

Step 3 – Initiative:

In combat it shares **your initiative** and acts right after you.

Step 4 – Commands:

It obeys your **verbal commands** at no action cost. Without a command it takes **Dodge**.

Step 5 – End:

It vanishes at **0 HP** or when the spell ends. A familiar rolls its own initiative and can't attack.

Example: Elora summons a wolf. It acts right after her. She shouts "Bite the leader!": it attacks. She says nothing: it dodges.

⚠ Common questions:

Which initiative?

The summoner's; it acts right after.

Does commanding cost an action?

No, a verbal command is enough.

What if no command?

It Dodges and avoids danger.

Is Concentration needed?

For most spells, yes.

Does the familiar attack?

No, it can't attack.

What at 0 HP?

It vanishes or is dismissed.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Complex commands

Can I give detailed orders? **Option**: one short sentence.

Intelligent creature

Can it disobey? **Option**: no, it's bound by the spell.

Broken Concentration

Do creatures leave at once? **Option**: yes.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Allies

Summons are allies, not independent NPCs.

Familiar

It rolls its own initiative.

Concentration

Breaking Concentration ends the summoning.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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